
Magistrate Wizard — Working A Docket Matter

Plain-language workflow. See the collected pack for the full set.

Magistrate Wizard

Architecture as implemented (migrations 0001–0067)

Court-anchored Docket · no admin bypass into private judicial content

13 August 2026

3. Working a docket matter

Who: a magistrate (or clerk) who can already open that Court's list

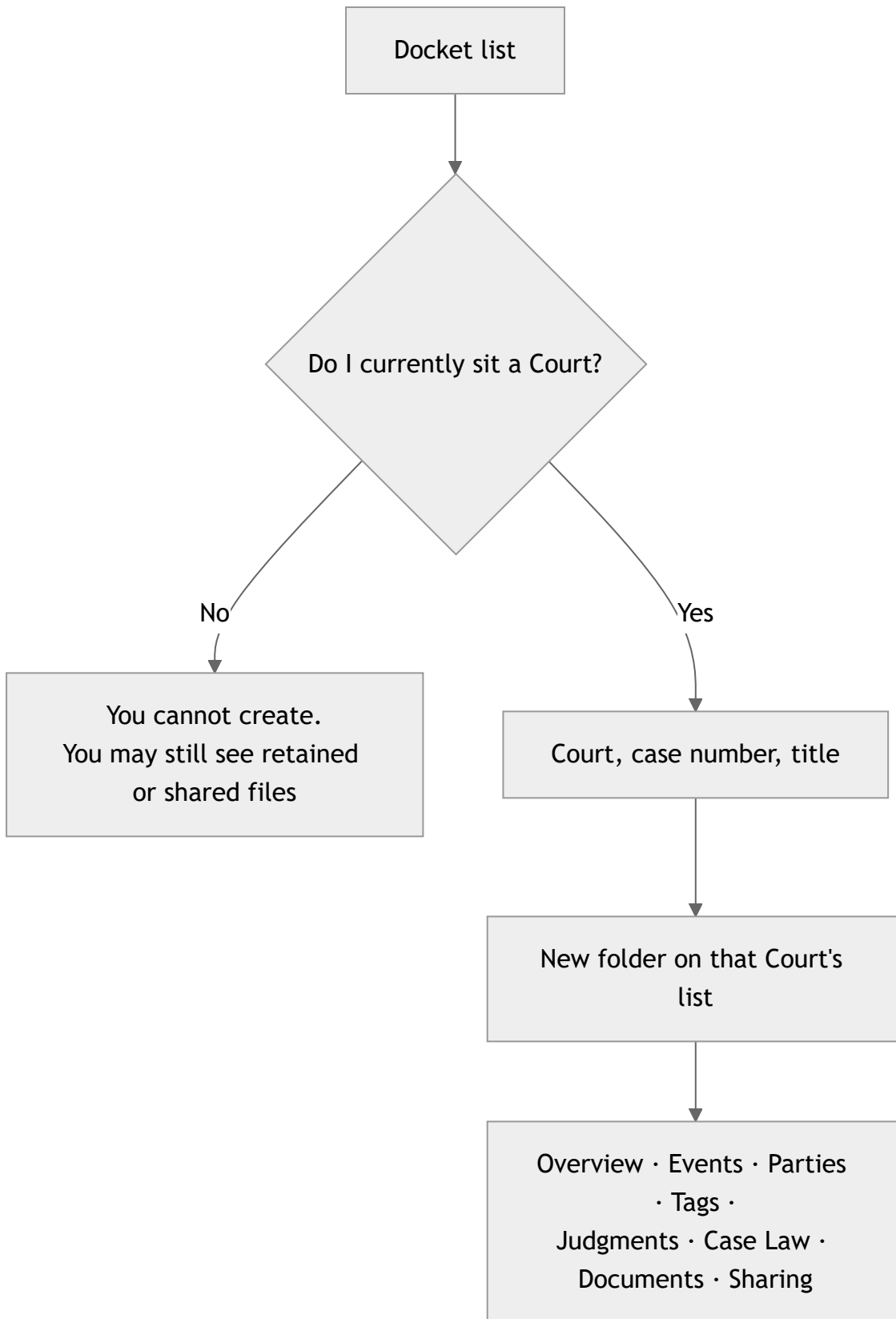
Goal: create and run one case file

Everyday analogy: opening a new folder in the Court's cabinet, not in your briefcase

Create a matter

1. Go to **Docket**.
2. Start a new matter.
3. Pick a Court you **currently sit**.
4. Enter the official **case number** and a short **title** (the names you would read out).
5. Save.

The district is filled in from the Court. You do not choose it. Case numbers must be unique **inside that district**, not worldwide — two districts may both have "45/2024".



The matter page

Tab	What it is for
Overview	Charge or issue, rolling orders, overall outcome, status, cover image, retain
Events	Each listed date
Parties	People and roles, optional identification photo
Tags	Court-visible labels such as "urgent" (not your private sticky notes)
Judgments	Pin <i>your</i> written rulings to this file
Case Law	Pin authorities you can read
Documents	PDFs and other attachments
Sharing	Let one named colleague in

You can bookmark the matter from the header.

Status

- **Active** — live
- **Stayed** — paused; a retained magistrate still keeps it
- **Completed** — finished; any retain ends automatically
- **Archived** — filed away; retain also ends

There is no "delete this case from history" button. That is the point of a court record.

Cover image

A cover photo (often a party's identification picture reused) appears on tiles and the top of the page. It is stored as a private file. Anyone who can already open the matter can see it.

If create is blocked

You are not currently assigned to the Court you picked. Ask an administrator to seat you, or work from a matter that was retained or shared with you.

What this file is not

It is not your personal notebook. Colleagues who later sit the same Court will see it. Put private thinking in **Bench Notes** or **personal Case Law**, not in the matter's institutional tags.